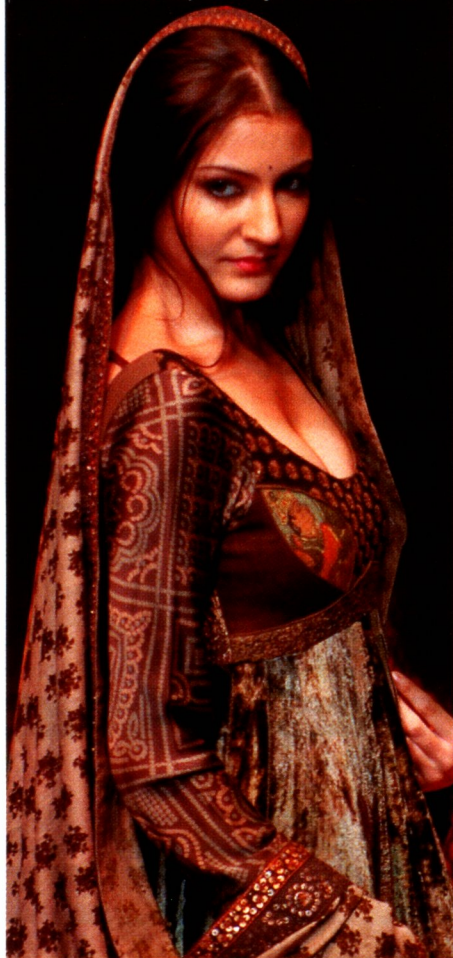


FIELD DAY

After weeks of anxiety, Aditya Chopra is a happy man. He has finally found the teen-queen for his third film as director, *Rab Ne Bana Di Jodi*. The 19-year-old **Anushka Sharma** from Bangalore has walked the Lakme India Fashion Week ramp for Wendell Rodericks and Sabyasachi Mukherjee and will now be seen opposite Shah Rukh Khan. The Chopras were looking for a girl to fit the mould of a small town Punjabi girl and they seem to have hit the jackpot. From the ramp to mustard fields, that's quite a transition.



Soaring High

The thing with John Abraham is that when he's in a film, all eyes are on him. But this will change soon. The new kid on 70 mm, **Sonal Sehgal**, will be playing the lead opposite Abraham in Nagesh Kukunoor's *Aashayein*. She first caught the camera's fancy in serials like *Hotel Kingston* and *Saara Aakash*. "I play a city girl and John and I are living together," says the 27-year-old, who quit TV after three years because nothing excited her. We hope her run on celluloid will be longer.



Wish Upon A Star

Losers can be winners as well. **Anwesha Dutt Gupta** will certainly tell you so. The Class IX singer may have lost out on the *Chhote Ustad* title, but she is living her Bollywood dream. The Kolkata girl is going to be crooning to composer Jatin Pandit's romantic tune in Saurabh Shukla's *M 24*. "The director chose me after watching the show, without an audition. I just practised the song for a few hours and recorded it," says the 14-year-old who's been learning classical music for 10 years. Three cheers to Gupta's musical high.

MISSILE WOMAN

Tessy Thomas has multiple monikers. Missile Woman and Agni Putri are just a few of them. The 45-year-old from Kerala, after all, is India's first woman scientist to head a strategic weapons project and was also part of the elite team responsible for Agni III. "It's a great sense of responsibility contributing to national security," says Thomas, who was one of the 10 chosen by the Defence Research and Development Organisation after a national entrance test in 1985. Superwoman, indeed.



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